

Qoobo

Revealed at CES 2020, the best way to describe Qoobo would be to call it a tailed, furry, robot. This tail reacts to touch and to sounds around it. The Qoobo has two versions, a full-sized version with a longer tail, and a smaller version dubbed Petit Qoobo which also has a smaller, stubbier tail. Qoobo's tail will move differently depending on how you stroke it, it's almost like it's attempting to simulate a cat. Actually, we're pretty sure that's exactly what Qoobo's trying to emulate, without all the hassle of needing to clean up after them. The different Qoobo



variants seemingly have different reactions with their "tails" with Petit Qoobo having more frantic movements and Qoobo having lazier reactions. This could also simply have to do with the fact that the larger Qoobo just needs more energy to move its larger "tail". That's not all though, Petit Qoobo also has a small heartbeat that you can feel when it's on your lap. There's also some actual science behind the Qoobo, as the simple act of stroking or petting, even something that merely "feels" alive, has shown stress relieving properties.



Milrem Robotics' Brushcutter and Forester

Estonia's University of Tartu and Milrem Robotics have partnered up to create two autonomous robots, forester robots specifically, which have been designed to be able to plant thousands of trees a day, autonomously. The two robots work together in tandem, and are both about the size of a small car. The Forester Planter is equipped with a planting payload that has a capacity of 380 seedlings. The Forester Brushcutter is designed to clear the brush for the planter to plant the seedlings. Both have been designed with temperate climate in mind, and the company claims that they're both pretty rugged and designed for harsh terrain and weather conditions. The Planter and Brushcutter both travel at a max speed of about 20km/h, and the planter has a planting speed of 5-6.5 hours per 2.5 acres. This timing depends on the kind of tree being planted and the kind of terrain as well. The idea is for the two to work together, with the Brushcutter trimming vegetation around the seedlings, or clearing the way for the planter to plant them. Navigation is accomplished using LiDAR, GPS and cameras.

Kubota Glasses

Japan's Kubota Pharmaceutical Holdings claims to have created a pair of glasses that can help cure nearsightedness or myopia without the need for surgery. Still currently in testing, the glasses can reportedly project images from the lens of the glasses onto the retina in order to correct the refractive error that causes nearsightedness. According to the company, simply wearing the device for 60 to 90 minutes a day can correct myopia.

Kubota Pharmaceuticals have not shared how exactly the device works,



however the device is going through clinical trials with the aim of trying to determine how long the effect lasts after using the device, and how many

days in total a user would have to wear the device in order to achieve permanent correction. Clinical trials for the Kubota Glasses began in July last year, and Kubota conducted tests on about 25 people in the U.S. However, they intend to sell the device in Asia first, since Asians are

the ones who are most prone to myopia. The company plans to begin selling the device in the second half of the year in select Asian countries.